

For Volunteers Staffing an A.A. Exhibit

Staffing an exhibit can be a rewarding way to do A.A. service. Here are a few suggestions we hope will be helpful to you.

First impressions matter! It is important that A.A. volunteers be courteous, punctual, and well-groomed.

Please choose appropriate clothing such as slacks, sweaters, sport coats, business suits, skirts, or dresses. Please do not wear jeans, sneakers, sweat clothes or shorts.

Professionals passing by a booth are more inclined to stop if they are given a warm smile or friendly greeting. When professionals approach the booth, we welcome them with a greeting or question such as:

- May we help you?
- Where are you from?
- Would you like some information on A.A.?

When speaking with professionals at the booth let them know:

- That everyone staffing the booth is a volunteer and member of A.A. This usually brings out some good questions.
- That if they would like to be connected with their local A.A. community that can be arranged.
- That you are not there to recruit them to be a member of A.A. but to explain how A.A. can be a resource to professionals who come into contact with problem drinkers through their work.
- That you're happy to answer any questions they may have about A.A. — and if you don't know the answer you can connect them with the Area C.P.C. Chair or the C.P.C. Coordinator at G.S.O.

A.A. literature and other material

Among the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine literature on display there may be new items you can highlight (people like knowing what is new) or items with particular relevance to the conference (for example at an HR conference you might point out the pamphlet "Is There a Problem Drinker in the Workplace?" and the Grapevine issue "A.A. in the Workplace").

Be sure to draw attention to our newsletter for professionals, About A.A. You'll have printed copies of the latest issue. You can also guide visitors to back issues which are available on www.aa.org and are indexed by topic (e.g., Medical Community, Legal, Corrections, etc.). If they'd like to receive the digital version of About A.A. all you need is their email address and you can sign them up on aa.org.

Most visitors to the booth won't want to take more than 2 or 3 items, though they are welcome to more. Let them know they can also have A.A. literature sent to them at no cost by filling out a P.I. label. Our mailings adhere to our principle of anonymity and do not indicate that A.A. is the source, if that is a concern.

Central Office/Intergroup Directories and local A.A. meeting lists are usually kept on hand as a reference for people visiting the booth and for travelling A.A. members who may wish to find a local meeting.

After the event, P.I. labels, About A.A. cards, or any sign-up sheets are given to whoever will be filling out the Evaluation form and sending it to G.S.O.

Thank you for your service!

Diana Lewis, C.P.C. Coordinator cpc@aa.org (212) 870-3107

Jacob Diaz, Coordinator of Exhibits diazj@aa.org (212) 870-3400 (ext.4732)

General Service Office, 475 Riverside Drive, 11th Floor, New York, N.Y. 10115